

CHAPTER 5

Prepositions, Conjunctions, and Transitions

Connecting words, logical relationships, and professional writing flow

Study • Practice • Review

Prepared as a structured learning handout

1. Learning Objectives

- Select appropriate prepositions for time, place, and direction.
- Combine clauses using coordinating and subordinating conjunctions.
- Use transition words to create logical flow in academic and professional writing.

2. Prepositions of Time, Place, and Direction

A preposition shows a relationship between a noun/pronoun and another part of a sentence.

A. Time: At, On, In

Preposition	Typical use	Examples
at	Precise times	at 5:00 PM, at midnight, at noon
on	Days and specific dates	on Monday, on October 15th
in	Months, years, seasons, longer periods	in July, in 2026, in summer

B. Place: At, On, In

- **At:** a specific point—at the door, at the bus stop, at the desk.
- **On:** a surface/contact—on the table, on the wall, on page 5.
- **In:** an enclosed space or area—in the room, in Kathmandu, in Nepal.

C. Direction & Movement

- **to:** destination—He walked to the library.
- **into:** movement inside—She stepped into the office.
- **onto:** movement onto a surface—The cat leaped onto the table.
- **through:** movement within a space—The train went through the tunnel.

3. Conjunctions: Connecting Ideas

A. Coordinating Conjunctions (FANBOYS)

For (reason) • And (addition) • Nor (negative addition) • But (contrast) • Or (option) • Yet (unexpected contrast) • So (result).

*I wanted to study, **but** I was tired. • The storm damaged the wires, **so** the power went out.*

B. Subordinating Conjunctions

Purpose	Common words	Example
Reason / cause	because, since, as	He failed because he did not prepare.
Time	when, while, after, before, until	Wash your hands before you eat.
Condition	if, unless, provided that	You will pass if you study regularly.
Contrast / concession	although, even though, whereas	Although it rained, they played.

4. Transition Words for Professional Writing

Purpose	Useful transitions
Addition	Furthermore, Moreover, In addition, Additionally
Contrast	However, On the other hand, Nevertheless, In contrast
Example	For example, For instance, To illustrate
Sequence	First, Secondly, Next, Then, Finally
Conclusion / result	In conclusion, Therefore, Consequently, Thus

5. Practice Exercises

A. Fill in with at, on, or in:

- 1 The workshop will take place _____ Friday, October 24th.
- 2 My brother works _____ an IT company _____ Kathmandu.
- 3 The train leaves precisely _____ 6:45 AM.
- 4 Leave your keys _____ the kitchen counter.
- 5 Nepal became a republic _____ 2008.

B. Join using because, although, but, so, or if:

- 1 The weather was cold. We went swimming in the lake.
- 2 She studied hard. She scored high marks on the exam.
- 3 You need to hurry. You will miss the morning bus.
- 4 I could not attend the class. I was sick.

6. Chapter Test

- 1 Complete: "The cat jumped _____ the table to grab the food." (onto / into)
- 2 What does FANBOYS stand for?
- 3 Combine using Although: "He is wealthy. He leads a simple life."
- 4 Insert a preposition: "I will meet you _____ the entrance of the building."
- 5 Identify the transition showing result: "He did not study; _____, he failed."

7. Answer Key

Practice A: 1. on 2. in; in 3. at 4. on 5. in.

Practice B: 1. Although the weather was cold, we went swimming in the lake. 2. She studied hard, so she scored high marks on the exam. 3. You need to hurry, or you will miss the morning bus. 4. I could not attend the class because I was sick.

Test: 1. onto 2. For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So 3. Although he is wealthy, he leads a simple life. 4. at 5. therefore / consequently / as a result.

Writing Tip: Choose transitions according to the relationship between ideas. Do not add “however,” “therefore,” or “moreover” simply because they sound formal.